

Chapter 2 — Worksheets and Activities

40 prompts

The difference between a worksheet that teaches and one that fills time is whether the difficulty is deliberate. These prompts build practice that ramps — starting where the class actually is, ending where you want them — and activities that keep running when you are on the other side of the room.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Practice worksheets	13	Independent practice that builds properly
Learning stations	8	Four ways into one topic, one period
Collaborative tasks	5	Group work where everyone has to think
Review games	5	Before an assessment, without the chaos
Homework sets	5	Work that survives leaving your room
Project briefs	5	Longer tasks students run themselves

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Ask for the answer key in the same request. Fetching it separately produces a key that does not quite match the questions.

Say how long students have. A worksheet built without a time limit is always too long.

For anything students do in groups, ask what you should look for while walking around. That line is usually the most useful part of the output.

PRACTICE WORKSHEETS

WA-001 Build a focused practice worksheet

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Independent practice on one skill, that gets harder in the right order.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a practice worksheet on [SKILL] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Students have [MINUTES] minutes. They have just been taught [WHAT YOU TAUGHT].

Structure it in four blocks:

- 2 warm-up items anyone who was present can do
- 5 core items that get harder one step at a time
- 2 items combining this with [EARLIER TOPIC]
- 1 challenge item

For each block, keep the difficulty change to one thing at a time – do not make the numbers harder and the wording harder in the same step.

Give me:

- The worksheet exactly as students receive it
- The full answer key, with working where the answer alone is not enough
- Which single item is the "if they get this, they have it" question
- The item most students will get wrong, and what that tells me

Do not pad the sheet to fill a page.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work the answer key yourself before photocopying.
- Does difficulty rise one step at a time, or jump?
- Can it honestly be finished in the time you gave?

WA-005 Create practice that moves from a model to independent work

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The gap between "we did it together" and "now do it alone" keeps losing people.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] practice sheet on [SKILL] that fades support across the page.

Four stages, in this order:

1. A fully worked example with the reasoning written out, to read not to do
2. The same kind of item with two steps done and the rest blank
3. The same kind with only the first step given
4. Three items with nothing given

The mathematics or content difficulty must stay the same across all four. The only thing changing is how much support is on the page.

Give me the sheet as students see it, the answer key, and one line telling me what it means if a student can do stage 2 but not stage 4.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the content difficulty genuinely constant across the four stages?
- Does the worked example show the thinking, or just the steps?

WA-006 Write a worksheet that targets one common misconception

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know exactly what they are getting wrong and want to go straight at it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

My [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students are making this error on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE ERROR – what they do, not what they fail to do]

Build a worksheet that confronts it.

Include:

- 3 items where the misconception produces a visibly wrong answer
- 2 items where the misconception happens to give the right answer, so students see that being right is not proof of understanding
- 1 item asking them to explain why a fictional student's wrong method fails
- 1 item where they have to decide which of two methods applies

Give me the answer key, and for each item say what a correct answer proves.

Do not simply re-explain the correct method. The sheet should make the wrong idea break in front of them.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the "accidentally right" items genuinely work that way? Check them.
- Is the fictional student's error the one your class actually makes?

WA-007 Build mixed practice that requires learners to choose a strategy

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do each method when told which one. Not when they have to decide.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a mixed practice sheet for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] covering these methods:

[LIST THE METHODS OR TOPICS]

Do not group the items by method and do not label which is which. Students must work out what applies.

Give me:

- 10 items in a deliberately mixed order
- 2 items where more than one method works, and which is more efficient
- 1 item where a plausible method does not work, and why
- The answer key, with the intended method noted for me only
- A one-line prompt I can put at the top asking students to name their method before solving

Tell me which pair of methods students most often confuse here.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the order genuinely mixed, or does a pattern creep back in?
- Does the "more than one works" item actually have two valid routes?

WA-008 Create a short retrieval worksheet for previously taught skills

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Keeping older learning alive without spending a lesson on it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 10-minute retrieval sheet for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Pull from:

- Last week: [TOPIC]
- Last month: [TOPIC]
- Last term: [TOPIC]

Two or three items from each, interleaved rather than grouped by topic. Everything must be answerable from memory – no reference material, no notes.

Give me:

- The sheet
- The answer key
- A one-line note per item on why it is worth keeping alive
- A version I could run next week with the same shape but different items

Do not introduce anything new. If a topic I listed needs something students have not been taught, say so instead of including it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything here new content in disguise?
- Are the older topics ones you genuinely taught this class?

WA-009 Design an application worksheet using realistic classroom contexts

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Word problems that do not insult the reader.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an application worksheet on [SKILL] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Use contexts a [GRADE] student would actually recognise. No talking animals, no scenarios where nobody would ever need the answer, and no situations that assume money, travel or possessions a family may not have.

Give me:

- 6 items in realistic contexts, increasing in how much the student has to extract from the wording
- 1 item containing information that is not needed, so they have to select
- 1 item where a required piece of information is missing, and the correct response is to say what is missing
- The answer key

Keep the reading demand appropriate for [GRADE]. If a context needs background knowledge some students may not have, flag it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do any contexts assume money, travel, or a kind of home life?
- Is the reading level right for your weakest reader?

WA-010 Adapt a worksheet for black-and-white printing and limited space

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One page, one side, and the colour printer is a fantasy.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rework the worksheet below so it prints on one side of one sheet in black and white.

Constraints:

- Nothing that depends on colour to be understood
- No shading that turns into a grey block on a school photocopier
- Enough writing space for a [GRADE] student's handwriting
- Readable at 100% – do not solve the space problem by shrinking the type

Give me:

- The reworked sheet
- What you cut or compressed, and what is lost
- Anywhere colour was carrying meaning, and what replaces it

If it genuinely will not fit on one side, say so and tell me the best two-page split.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the writing space enough for actual handwriting?
- Print one copy on the real photocopier before running thirty.

WA-011 Create an error-analysis worksheet from fictional student work

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Finding the mistake teaches more than avoiding it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an error-analysis worksheet on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Use fictional students – invented names like "Student A" – and invented work. Do not ask me to supply real student work, and do not imply the examples are real.

Give me 4 pieces of fictional work:

- One with a single clear error
- One where the method is right and the arithmetic is wrong
- One where the arithmetic is right and the method is wrong
- One that is fully correct but looks unusual

For each, students must say: what was done, where it goes wrong, and what to do instead. Give me the answers.

Then tell me which of the four is hardest to diagnose, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the errors realistic ones your students make?
- Is the "correct but unusual" one genuinely correct? Check it.

WA-012 Write a worksheet with foundation, application and reasoning sections

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One sheet the whole class can work on at their own depth.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a three-section worksheet on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Section 1 – Foundation: can the student do the procedure

Section 2 – Application: can they use it in a context

Section 3 – Reasoning: can they explain, justify, or spot when it does not apply

Every student attempts all three sections. The sections are not ability groups and must not be labelled as such.

Give me:

- 4 items in section 1, 3 in section 2, 2 in section 3
- The answer key
- What it means if a student is fine in section 1 and stuck in section 3
- A single reasoning item I could put on the board for the whole class

Keep section 3 accessible to a student who found section 1 hard – it should demand different thinking, not more of the same.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student who struggled in section 1 still attempt section 3?
- Do the sections test different things, or the same thing three times?

WA-013 Audit and repair a worksheet whose questions are repetitive or unclear

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The sheet exists. It is not working and you are not sure why.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] worksheet.

For each item tell me:

- What it actually asks the student to do
- Whether it adds anything the previous items did not already test
- Any wording open to more than one reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand is higher than the subject demand

Then:

- Name the items I could delete without losing anything
- Rewrite the two worst-worded items
- Tell me what the sheet never tests but should

Be direct. If the sheet is ten versions of the same question, say so.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree the flagged items are genuinely redundant?
- Do the rewrites still test what you wanted?

WA-002 Design four learning stations

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One topic, four ways in, one period.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [MINUTES] minutes each.

Class size: [NUMBER]. Materials available: [LIST].

Each station uses a different mode – one hands-on, one reading, one talking, one writing – and must run without me standing at it.

For each station give me:

- The instruction card exactly as students read it, under 40 words
- Materials, using only what I listed
- What students leave behind as evidence
- What I check in the three seconds I walk past
- What the group does if they finish early

Then give me the rotation table and what I say to start each rotation.

Flag anything needing materials I have not listed.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a group genuinely run each station without you?
- Do the four stations fit the materials you actually have?

LEARNING STATIONS

WA-014 Create hands-on, reading, discussion and writing stations

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want four genuinely different kinds of thinking, not four worksheets.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where each demands a different kind of thinking, not just a different activity.

- Hands-on: students manipulate something and notice a pattern
- Reading: students extract specific information from a short text
- Discussion: students must disagree productively about something
- Writing: students explain or justify in their own words

For each: the instruction card, materials, the evidence left behind, and the one thing that usually goes wrong there.

Then tell me which station is the hardest to run well, and what to do about it.

The four should build on each other in any order – a student should not need to do the reading station before the hands-on one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the four genuinely demand different thinking?
- Does any station secretly depend on doing another one first?

WA-015 Plan station rotations for a large class and small room

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty-two students, a room built for twenty-four, and you still want stations.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I have [NUMBER] students in a room that is [DESCRIBE THE SPACE – desks fixed or movable, floor space, how many can stand at once].

Plan station rotations for [NUMBER OF STATIONS] stations in [MINUTES] minutes.

Give me:

- Group sizes and how many groups
- The physical layout, described so I could sketch it
- The rotation order, and the route each group walks so paths do not cross
- What I say to move them, under 15 seconds
- The realistic transition time, counted into the total
- What changes if two students are absent, or two extra arrive

Do not assume I can move furniture. If the plan needs a bigger room, say so and give me the best version that fits this one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the walking routes actually work in your room?
- Is transition time counted in, or bolted on at the end?

WA-016 Build self-checking stations that do not depend on the teacher

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want to be at one station, not answering "is this right?" from four.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design [NUMBER] stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where students can check their own work.

Each station needs a self-check that does not simply hand over the answer – for

example a total that must match, a pattern that only appears if the work is right, or a card that gives the answer only after a written attempt.

For each station:

- The task
- The self-check mechanism, described so I can build it from paper
- What students do when the check fails
- What stops a student skipping to the answer

Then tell me which station will still generate questions for me, and what those questions will be.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a student get the answer without doing the work?
- Can you build every check from paper this week?

WA-017 Create one quiet station and three collaborative stations

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Some students need to work in silence, and that should not be a punishment.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT]: three collaborative and one where students work alone in silence.

The quiet station must be as interesting as the others – not the leftover worksheet. A student choosing quiet should not be choosing less.

Give me:

- All four station cards
- What makes the quiet station genuinely worth doing
- How a student ends up at the quiet station without announcing anything about themselves
- How I keep the noise from the other three from reaching it

Do not label it as being for anyone in particular.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student see the quiet station as a downgrade?
- Can a student choose it without drawing attention?

WA-018 Differentiate station access while preserving one shared objective

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Same destination, different entry points, one discussion at the end.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] stations on [TOPIC], build in different entry points while keeping one shared objective.

For each station give me:

- The core task
- A supported version – more scaffolding, same thinking
- An extended version – same topic, harder thinking, not more questions
- What every version produces, so they all feed one closing discussion

The versions must not be labelled by ability, and a student should be able to move between them without asking permission.

Tell me how the closing discussion works when different students did different versions.

STATIONS:

[PASTE THEM, or describe the topic and I will design them]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the class decide which version is "the easy one"?
- Does the closing discussion genuinely include all three?

WA-019 Design a teacher-led reteaching station from exit-ticket evidence

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have ten minutes with the group that needs you, while the rest run stations.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Last lesson's exit ticket on [TOPIC] showed this pattern in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – no student names]

Design a 10-minute teacher-led station that addresses it, to run while other groups work independently.

Give me:

- What I do in the first two minutes to find out where each student actually is
- The reteach, aimed at the thinking rather than the procedure
- Two questions I ask that reveal whether it has landed
- What each student takes away to try alone
- How I keep it to 10 minutes when it wants to run to 20

Assume I cannot see the rest of the room properly while I am doing this – tell me what to set up beforehand so it survives my not looking.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is ten minutes realistic for this reteach?
- Is the rest of the room genuinely self-sufficient for that long?

WA-020 Audit station directions, timing, materials and accountability

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you laminate eight cards and find out on the day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] stations.

Check each one for:

- Instructions a student could misread, quoted exactly
- Whether the task fits the time given, honestly
- Materials assumed but never listed
- Whether anything is produced that I could actually look at afterwards
- Whether a student could sit through the whole rotation doing nothing

Then tell me:

- Which station will fail first, and why
- The smallest fix for it
- Which station is doing the least work for the time it takes

Be blunt about the weak one.

STATIONS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with which station it called weakest?
- Is the timing judgement based on your class, or an ideal one?

COLLABORATIVE TASKS

WA-003 Create an accountable group task

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Group work where one student cannot carry the other three.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute group task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], groups of [NUMBER].

Build the accountability into the task itself, not into a peer-rating form.

Give me:

- A task that genuinely needs more than one person – not one job split up
- What each student personally produces, identifiable as theirs
- A group product that cannot be completed unless every part arrives
- One question I ask any individual at the end to check they understood the whole thing, not only their piece
- What I do about the group where one student did most of it

Tell me plainly whether a passenger could still get through this task. If yes, fix it before giving me the final version.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could one strong student do the whole thing alone? Redesign if so.
- Does every student leave something with their own name on it?

WA-021 Design a jigsaw task where every learner holds essential information

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Everyone is necessary, and the task proves it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a jigsaw task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Groups of [NUMBER]. Each student gets a different piece, and the final task is impossible without all of them.

Give me:

- The [NUMBER] information pieces, written out in full and roughly equal in difficulty and length
- The final task, which cannot be done from any one piece
- The expert-group step: what students with the same piece do together first
- The exact instruction for teaching your piece to your group
- What I check to know a piece was genuinely taught rather than handed over
- What happens when a student is absent and their piece is missing

No piece should be obviously the easy one or obviously the important one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the pieces genuinely equal in difficulty?
- Is the final task truly impossible from one piece? Try it.

WA-022 Build a group investigation with rotating cognitive roles

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Roles that mean thinking, not roles that mean stationery.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a group investigation into [QUESTION] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], groups of [NUMBER], over [MINUTES] minutes.

Give each student a role defined by the thinking it demands – for example the one who challenges every claim, the one who checks the evidence, the one who tracks what is still unknown. No timekeepers, no material-fetchers, no scribes-as-a-role.

For each role give me:

- What that student is responsible for thinking about
- Two sentences they can say to do their job when they get stuck
- What goes wrong in the group when nobody does it

Then tell me when roles rotate, and what students carry over when they change.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every role about thinking, or is one just admin?
- Would a shy student be able to perform their role?

WA-023 Create a consensus task that requires evidence and disagreement

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them to argue about the content, properly.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a consensus task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where groups must reach agreement they can defend.

Requirements:

- A genuinely arguable question with more than one defensible answer
- Evidence provided in the task, so students argue from something rather than from opinion
- A rule that a group cannot agree until they can state the strongest case against their own answer
- What a group records, including where they disagreed and how it resolved

Give me the task, the evidence, sentence starters for disagreeing without it becoming personal, and what I look for while circulating.

Do not choose a question where one answer is obviously right.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the question genuinely arguable, or is there a right answer?
- Is the supplied evidence enough to argue from?

WA-024 Turn an individual worksheet into meaningful collaborative reasoning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The worksheet is fine. Doing it in pairs would be better than doing it twice.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Convert this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] worksheet into a task worth doing in pairs.

The point is not to halve the work. Restructure it so two people thinking produce something one person could not.

Options to consider: each student gets different items and must explain theirs;
one solves while the other predicts and they compare; both attempt separately then reconcile differences.

Give me:

- The restructured task
- The exact instruction pairs receive
- What each student still produces individually
- The one moment in the task where they genuinely have to talk

If this worksheet is better done alone, say so rather than forcing it.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the pair version better, or just louder?
- Does each student still leave individual evidence?

WA-025 Audit a group task for participation, access and individual evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It looked collaborative. You are not sure it was.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group task.

Tell me:

- Whether one student could complete it alone while the others watch
- Where a quiet student can contribute without having to compete for airtime
- What evidence I get about each individual, and what I only get about the group
- Anything that assumes a skill unrelated to the objective – presenting, drawing, reading quickly – and whether that is fair here
- Whether the task actually needs a group

End with the single change that would most improve it. If the honest answer is that this should be individual work, say that.

TASK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with what it said about passengers?
- Are you comfortable with how little individual evidence there is?

REVIEW GAMES

WA-004 Build a review game that measures learning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A game that also tells you who is ready for the test.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [NUMBER] students.

It must give me usable information about who knows what – not just a winner.

Give me:

- The rules, in under 60 words, as I would say them
- [NUMBER] questions covering the whole topic, with answers
- How every student answers every question, so I am not sampling the confident
- What I record while it runs, without stopping the game
- How points work so a team that is behind can still catch up, and nobody is eliminated
- What I do with what I learned, next lesson

No speed-based scoring – it rewards the fast, not the correct.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every student answer every question, or only the loud ones?
- Can you actually record anything while running it?

WA-026 Create a no-speed review game using mini-whiteboards

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Everyone answers, you see all thirty at once, nobody is racing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a mini-whiteboard review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

All students answer every question and hold up on a signal, so nobody is rewarded for being fast.

Give me:

- The signal routine, in the words I use
- 12 questions with short answers I can read across a room at a glance
- The answers
- What I do when I see a wrong answer held up – the exact words, not shaming
- Two questions designed so the wrong answers tell me something specific
- How I keep score without making a slower student the reason a team lost

Tell me which questions to keep if I only get through half.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the answers short enough to read at a distance?
- Does your response to a wrong board avoid singling anyone out?

WA-027 Design a team review game with individual accountability

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Teams, but the strong student cannot answer for everyone.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a team review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], teams of [NUMBER].

Build in a rule that means any team member might have to answer, so the whole team has to make sure everyone understands.

Give me:

- The rules, in under 60 words
- How the answering student is chosen so it is unpredictable but not frightening
- [NUMBER] questions with answers, mixed in difficulty
- Team discussion time before answering, and how long
- What stops one student from simply telling the others the answer
- How I handle a team that leaves a member behind

Nobody is eliminated and no team is out of the running before the end.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a struggling student find the selection method frightening?
- Is there real reason for teams to teach each other?

WA-028 Build a misconception challenge using diagnostic distractors

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A game where the wrong answers are the whole point.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a review activity on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] built from multiple-choice questions where every wrong option is a real misconception.

Give me 10 questions. For each:

- The question and four options
- The correct answer
- What a student choosing each wrong option is thinking
- Whether that misconception is common enough to be worth teaching into

No throwaway distractors. If I cannot name the thinking behind an option, it should not be there.

Then tell me the three misconceptions most worth a follow-up lesson, and what that lesson would open with.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you name the thinking behind every wrong option?
- Are these misconceptions your class actually has?

WA-029 Create a low-prep review game with paper question cards

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Tomorrow morning, scissors, and nothing else.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] needing nothing but paper I print and cut tonight.

No devices, no board, no buying anything, no laminating.

Give me:

- The cards, laid out so I can print and cut them in one pass
- How many sets I need for [NUMBER] students, and how many students per set
- The rules, under 50 words, printable on a card students keep
- How students check answers without me
- What I do with the sets afterwards so they are reusable

Tell me exactly how long the printing and cutting will take. If it is more than fifteen minutes, simplify it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the prep honestly under fifteen minutes?
- Can students check answers without you?

WA-030 Audit a review game for fairness, accuracy and useful teacher data

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It was fun. You are not sure it taught or told you anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] review game.

Tell me:

- Whether every student participates, or only the confident ones
- Whether it rewards speed, luck or volume over knowing the answer
- Whether a student can be eliminated or publicly wrong, and what that costs
- What information I actually get about who knows what
- Whether any question is wrong, ambiguous, or tests something else

Then give me the single change that would make it most useful to me as assessment, without making it less enjoyable.

GAME:

[PASTE THE RULES AND QUESTIONS]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check any question it flagged as wrong, yourself.
- Are you willing to lose some of the fun for the information?

HOMEWORK SETS

WA-031 Create a short homework set with a clear purpose

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Homework that is worth the argument it causes at home.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework set on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], designed to take [MINUTES] minutes.

State the purpose first – practice, retrieval, or preparation for next lesson –
and build only for that.

Give me:

- The purpose in one sentence, printed at the top for the family to read
- The items, no more than the time allows
- The answer key
- The one item I mark first to learn the most
- What a student does if they get stuck and nobody at home can help

Nothing that needs the internet, a printer, an adult who knows the subject, or materials a household may not have.

If [MINUTES] is not enough for the purpose, tell me rather than overfilling it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Time it honestly. Homework always takes longer than planned.
- Could a student with no help at home complete this?

WA-032 Build homework that mixes retrieval and current learning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Keeping the old alive while practising the new.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework set for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] mixing:

- Today's learning: [TOPIC]
- Something from last month: [TOPIC]
- Something from last term: [TOPIC]

Roughly half on today's work, half on the older material, interleaved rather than in sections.

Give me:

- The items and answer key
- Why each older item is worth keeping alive
- What it tells me if a student gets today's work right and last term's wrong
- A version for next week with the same structure, so I can see the pattern

Total time: [MINUTES]. Do not exceed it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the older material genuinely taught to this class?
- Does the mix fit the time?

WA-033 Design homework with a meaningful no-internet option

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Not every student has a device or a connection, and that is not their fault.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] in two versions of equal value: one using a device, one entirely on paper.

The paper version must not be the lesser option. Same learning, same effort, same standing.

Give me:

- Both versions
- What each produces, so I can mark them the same way
- How a student chooses without announcing anything about their home
- The answer key for both

Do not put the paper version in brackets as an alternative. Print both as equal choices.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student feel marked out by choosing paper?
- Are the two genuinely equal in demand?

WA-034 Create a family-readable homework guide without requiring family teaching

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Families want to help, and should not have to teach the method.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short note to families explaining tonight's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] homework on [TOPIC].

It must help without asking the family to teach anything.

Include:

- What the homework is for, in two sentences and no jargon
- What "helping" looks like here – the questions to ask rather than the answers to give
- What to do if the student is stuck for more than [MINUTES] minutes: stop, write a note, and it is fine
- One line making clear that not finishing is information for me, not a failure

Under 150 words. Written for any adult, at any reading level, in any home situation. Do not assume a parent, a quiet room, or subject knowledge.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it assume a parent rather than any adult?
- Is "stop after X minutes" permission clear enough to be believed?

WA-035 Audit a homework set for workload, access and answer-key accuracy

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before thirty families spend an evening on it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] homework set.

Tell me:

- How long it will realistically take a middling student, versus what I claimed
- Anything needing internet, a printer, materials, or adult subject knowledge
- Anything a student who was absent could not do
- Any item where the answer key is wrong or the question is ambiguous – quote it
- Whether the whole set has a purpose, or is just volume

Then tell me what to cut so it fits [MINUTES] minutes, and what is lost.

Check every answer.

HOMEWORK:

[PASTE IT WITH THE KEY]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify any answer it flagged, yourself.
- Is the realistic timing closer to the truth than yours was?

PROJECT BRIEFS

WA-036 Write a student-ready project brief from a supplied objective

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A brief students can follow without asking you what it means.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a project brief for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], to run over [TIME].

Objective: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Write it for students, not for me. Include:

- What they are making, in one sentence
- Why it is worth making
- What it must contain – the parts that are about the learning, listed first
- What is up to them
- Deadlines, with what is due at each
- How it will be judged, in the words I will actually use
- The three questions students will ask on day one, answered in advance

Keep it to one page. If the objective is too large for [TIME], say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student start without asking you a question?
- Is the learning listed before the presentation?

WA-037 Create project milestones, checkpoints and submission requirements

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So you find out in week two, not the night before it is due.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break this [TIME] [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project into milestones.

Give me:

- A milestone per [WEEK/LESSON], each producing something I can look at
- What "on track" and "behind" look like at each
- The specific intervention for a group behind at each point
- The checkpoint that catches a project heading for failure earliest
- What students see, so they can self-monitor without me chasing them
- The final submission requirements, listed as a checklist students tick

Each checkpoint must be checkable in under two minutes per student or group.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE BRIEF]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Two minutes per group — is that honest for your class size?
- Is the first checkpoint early enough to rescue a bad start?

WA-038 Design a choice-based project with equivalent learning demands

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Real choice, without one option being obviously the easy one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design [NUMBER] project options on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], all evidencing the same objective: [OBJECTIVE]

They must be genuinely equivalent in demand. Not one written, one poster, one video where the poster is clearly least work.

For each option give me:

- What the student produces
- How the objective is evidenced through it
- The time it honestly takes
- What makes it hard – the thinking, not the format

Then tell me which option students will pick expecting it to be easier, and whether they are right. If they are, fix that option.

None should need resources a student may not have at home.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which would you pick if you wanted to do least? Fix that one.
- Does any option need equipment from home?

WA-039 Build a group-project brief with individual evidence of mastery

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A group grade that does not hide who learned what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a group project brief for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] on [TOPIC], groups of [NUMBER], over [TIME].

Every student must leave individual evidence of the objective, separate from the group product.

Give me:

- The brief as students receive it
- The group product
- The individual component each student produces, which cannot be done by someone else on their behalf
- How the two are marked separately
- What I do about a group where one student did most of the work
- What happens when a group member is absent for a week

Tell me honestly whether a passenger could pass. If yes, change the design.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a passenger pass? That is the whole test of this brief.
- Is the individual component quick enough to mark for every student?

WA-040 Audit a project brief for clarity, feasibility and privacy

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you hand it out and spend three weeks answering questions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project brief.

Tell me:

- Anything a student could reasonably misread, quoted exactly
- Whether it fits the time given, honestly
- Anything requiring money, internet, transport, adult help, or equipment a household may not have
- Whether the marking rewards the learning or the presentation
- Anything that would put a student's name, image, work or personal details in front of an audience, and what needs consent first
- The three questions students will ask on day one that the brief does not answer

Give me the single change that would help most.

I will check anything involving consent or sharing against my school's policy.

BRIEF:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check consent and sharing against your school's policy, not this draft.
- Are the day-one questions ones you can answer now?